

Ecclesiastical Latin

EL-I.2: Case, Number, Gender, and Agreement

Choose and justify nominal forms from case function, agreement, and government, including syncretic endings

Stage	Stage I — Foundations
Prerequisite	EL-I.1 mastery: distinguish form from function and produce a basic clause map
Next	EL-I.3, First and Second Declension Nouns

Read *EL-GUIDE: Start Here* before using this packet. Course method, pacing, source conventions, and answer protocol are stated there; this module begins with its lesson and assumes previously taught terms.

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Part I

Lesson

CHAPTER 1

Unit 2: Case, Number, Gender, and Agreement

On completing this unit, you can:

- name the six commonly taught Latin cases, including the vocative, and state their core functions;
- distinguish morphological case from an English translation word such as “of”, “to”, or “with”;
- make adjectives agree with nouns in case, number, and gender; and
- parse short liturgical phrases before translating them.

1.1 The case map

Case is the grammatical category, usually signaled by inflection, that helps mark a noun, pronoun, or adjective’s relation in its sentence. **Number** says whether the form is singular or plural. **Gender** classifies a noun as masculine, feminine, or neuter and controls the gender of words agreeing with it; grammatical gender does not necessarily describe biological sex. A word’s **syntactic function** is the job it performs in its phrase or clause, such as subject, object, possessor, or recipient. Case is the form; function is the contextual job, so the same case can perform several functions.

Case	Core work	Diagnostic question
Nominative	subject; predicate noun or adjective	What controls the finite verb? What is predicated or identified?
Genitive	possession, source, description, part	Of whom or of what?
Dative	recipient, beneficiary, reference	To or for whom?
Accusative	direct object; goal after certain prepositions	Whom or what is affected? Toward/into what?
Ablative	separation, source, means, manner, accompaniment, location	By, with, from, or in what?
Vocative	direct address	Whom is the speaker addressing?
Locative remnants	place where in a few names and nouns	Where?

Case is a form, not a translation. An ablative can be translated “with”, “by”, “from”, or another phrase according to context. A dative may need “to” in English even when no Latin word for “to” appears. First identify the form; then state its syntactic use; only then choose English.

1.2 Agreement and government

Agreement means that one word matches grammatical features of another. An adjective agrees with its noun in **case, number, and gender**, but the noun and adjective need not display the same letters. In *Spiritui Sancto*, both words are dative singular masculine even though one ends in *-ui* and the other in *-o*. **Government** means that a word requires its dependent to take a particular form. Thus a preposition

governs a case: *cum* takes the ablative; *ad* takes the accusative. A verb can also govern a case, as *miserere* takes a genitive or dative object in ecclesiastical usage. Agreement matches features; government imposes a form. Do not confuse the two.

A complete nominal parse

For every noun, adjective, or pronoun write: dictionary form; case; number; gender; syntactic function; contextual sense. If a form permits more than one case, list the possibilities and eliminate them by agreement, government, and clause structure.

Worked example: *Gloria Patri, et Filio, et Spiritui Sancto*

Worked passage ID: W.I.4; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Gloria is nominative singular and names what is ascribed: “glory”. *Patri, Filio,* and *Spiritui* are coordinated dative singular recipients: “to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Spirit”. *Sancto* is dative singular masculine and agrees with *Spiritui*. Translation: “Glory to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit.”

Worked example: *Agnus Dei, qui tollis peccata mundi*

Worked passage ID: W.I.5; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Agnus is nominative singular masculine, used as direct address with a nominative-shaped liturgical title. *Dei* is genitive singular, “of God”. *qui* is nominative singular masculine because it refers to *Agnus* and is the subject of *tollis*. *peccata* is accusative plural neuter, direct object; *mundi* is genitive singular. Translation: “Lamb of God, who take away the sins of the world.”

Worked example: *Pax hominibus bonæ voluntatis* (Lk 2:14)

Worked passage ID: W.I.6; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Pax is nominative singular in a verbless nominal acclamation or wish; conventional English may supply “be”, while analytic Latin may mark interpretive [*sit*]. *hominibus* is dative plural, the recipients of peace. *voluntatis* is genitive singular; *bonæ* agrees with it as genitive singular feminine. Literal translation: “Peace to human beings of good will.”

Worked example: *Domine, non sum dignus*

Worked passage ID: W.I.7; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Domine is vocative singular of *dominus*. *sum* is first singular present; its subject *ego* is contained in the ending. *dignus* is nominative singular masculine, a predicate adjective agreeing with the understood subject. Translation: “Lord, I am not worthy.”

1.3 Handwritten study and controlled composition

Copy the case map from memory. For each worked phrase, draw arrows from every adjective or relative pronoun to its antecedent or noun, and write C–N–G (case–number–gender) above both. Then compose “glory to the holy Son” from *gloria*, *filius*, and *sanctus*; model: *gloria Filio sancto*. Change only the recipient to plural “to the holy sons”: *filiis sanctis*. Explain every changed ending.

Part II

Practice

CHAPTER 1

Transfer, retrieval, and application

1.1 The case map — transfer practice

Connection. Syncretic endings make a decision process more reliable than memorizing one English cue for each case.

Transfer task. For the project-composed phrase *servi domini*, list every morphologically possible analysis of each form before context. Then test the two clause frames *servi dominum laudant* and *vox servi auditur*.

Retrieval check. State the three questions to ask after an ending permits more than one case or number.

1.2 Agreement and government — transfer practice

Connection. Agreement copies grammatical coordinates; government assigns a required case. Confusing the two hides why an ending changes.

Transfer task. Draw arrows in the lesson's agreement examples from each adjective to its controlling noun and from each governed noun to its governor. Label every arrow either agreement or government.

Retrieval check. Without notes, explain why agreeing words need not share the same visible ending.

1.3 Handwritten study and controlled composition — transfer practice

Connection. A transformation is useful only when each changed ending can be tied to a changed grammatical coordinate.

Transfer task. Repeat the lesson's recipient transformation, but annotate each changed word with old coordinates, new coordinates, and the rule that forces the change.

Retrieval check. Name one form that stayed unchanged and explain why no grammatical coordinate changed.

Part III

Worksheets

CHAPTER 1

Unit 2: Case and Agreement

Worksheet I.5 — Variant A

Worksheet ID: I.5

Focus: Case functions, agreement, and ambiguity resolved by syntax**Use:** Give case, number, function, and translation where requested.

1. Match each case to its core function: nominative, genitive, dative, accusative, ablative, vocative; subject, possession, recipient, direct object, circumstance/prepositional object, direct address.

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2. Parse *Patri* and *Filio* in *Gloria Patri, et Filio*: state all four coordinates and function.

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3. In *anima bona*, change both words together to accusative singular and nominative plural.

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4. Transform *Dominus custodit animam*, “the Lord guards the soul”, into “the soul guards the Lord”.

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5. Diagnose *Deus laudat gloria* if the intended meaning is “God praises glory”; correct and explain.

-
6. **Text:** *Pax hominibus bonæ voluntatis*.

Passage ID: I.5.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Parse the three nouns and translate, marking any interpretive expansion.

Worksheet I.8 — Variant D**Worksheet ID:** I.8**Focus:** Case contrasts, coordinated phrases, and correction**Use:** Do not use word position as proof of case.

1. Give the Latin case expected for each italicized relation: glory *to God*; Body *of Christ*; *with the spirit*; hear *the word*; *O Father*.
-

2. Parse *animam meam* and *Corpus Domini* by coordinates and relation.
-

3. Transform *Deus bonus animam custodit* so that plural gods guard plural souls.
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4. Explain why *Patris* and *Patri* are not interchangeable in “the name of the Father” and “glory to the Father”.
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5. Diagnose and correct *dona nos pacem*, intended “grant us peace”.
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6. **Text:** *Corpus Domini nostri Iesu Christi custodiat animam meam.*

Passage ID: I.8.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Draw the genitive and agreement links, identify subject and object, and translate.

Part IV

Assessment

CHAPTER 1

Mastery assessment and record

Advance when: Parse at least 18 of 20 nominal forms correctly in context, naming both case and function, and repair four of five broken agreement pairs by identifying the controlling noun and the rule that requires each ending.

Complete the assessment before opening the answer part. Record evidence, not confidence or elapsed time.

Evidence	First attempt	Delayed check
Date and conditions		
Worksheet ID and score		
Mastery task and result		
One recurring error family		
Correction stated as a rule		
Unseen or remediation item used		

If the criterion is met: continue to EL-I.3, First and Second Declension Nouns.

If it is not met: Worksheets I.6 and I.7 remain optional remediation or delayed-recall variants.

Advance / remediate decision: _____ **Next review date:** _____

Reason in one complete sentence: _____

Part V

Answer Key

Open this part only after completing the assessment record. Use the comparison and alternative-answer protocol in EL-GUIDE.

CHAPTER 1

Practice models and rubrics

The case map — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. Before context, *servi* can include nominative plural or genitive singular, and *domini* can include nominative plural or genitive singular. In the first project-composed clause, finite plural *laudant* supports nominative plural *servi*, while accusative *dominum* is object. In the second, singular *vox* is subject and *servi* is genitive singular. A complete decision tree asks what the ending permits, what function the clause requires, and what agreement or government confirms it.

Agreement and government — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. Every agreement arrow must preserve case, number, and gender; every government arrow must name the governing verb, adjective, preposition, or construction and its required case. A sound retrieval answer notes that nouns and adjectives may belong to different declensional patterns, so grammatical coordinates rather than letter-for-letter endings agree.

Handwritten study and controlled composition — model and rubric

Model / acceptable evidence. The annotations must show that plural recipient forms become dative plural and that every agreeing adjective follows its noun's new coordinates. Any unchanged form is acceptable only when its case, number, gender, and function truly remain the same; visual resemblance alone is not a reason.

CHAPTER 2

Unit 2: Case and Agreement

Solution I.5 — Variant A

Worksheet ID: I.5

Focus: Case functions, agreement, and ambiguity resolved by syntax

Use: Give case, number, function, and translation where requested.

1. Match each case to its core function: nominative, genitive, dative, accusative, ablative, vocative; subject, possession, recipient, direct object, circumstance/prepositional object, direct address.

Answer / model: Nominative–subject; genitive–possession or description; dative–recipient; accusative–direct object; ablative–circumstance or object of an ablative-governing preposition; vocative–direct address.

2. Parse *Patri* and *Filio* in *Gloria Patri, et Filio*: state all four coordinates and function.

Answer / model: Both are masculine singular dative and recipients of the wished glory: “to the Father and to the Son”.

3. In *anima bona*, change both words together to accusative singular and nominative plural.

Answer / model: Accusative singular: *animam bonam*. Nominative plural: *animæ bonæ*. The adjective changes because it must match gender, number, and case.

4. Transform *Dominus custodit animam*, “the Lord guards the soul”, into “the soul guards the Lord”.

Answer / model: *Anima custodit Dominum*. The noun endings, not merely position, exchange subject and object.

5. Diagnose *Deus laudat gloria* if the intended meaning is “God praises glory”; correct and explain.

Answer / model: *Deus laudat gloriam*. *Gloriam* must be accusative singular because it is the direct object; *gloria* would normally be nominative or ablative singular.

6. **Text:** *Pax hominibus bonæ voluntatis*.

Passage ID: I.5.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Parse the three nouns and translate, marking any interpretive expansion.

Answer / notes: *Pax*: feminine singular nominative in a verbless acclamation or wish. *hominibus*: masculine plural dative, recipient. *voluntatis*: feminine singular genitive, dependent on *hominibus*; *bonæ* agrees with it. Conventional English supplies “be”; analytic Latin may mark interpretive [*sit*]. “Peace [be] to people of good will.”

Solution I.8 — Variant D

Worksheet ID: I.8

Focus: Case contrasts, coordinated phrases, and correction

Use: Do not use word position as proof of case.

1. Give the Latin case expected for each italicized relation: *glory to God*; *Body of Christ*; *with the spirit*; *hear the word*; *O Father*.
Answer / model: Dative; genitive; ablative after *cum*; accusative direct object; vocative.
2. Parse *animam meam* and *Corpus Domini* by coordinates and relation.
Answer / model: *animam meam*: feminine singular accusative noun and agreeing possessive, an object phrase. *Corpus*: neuter singular nominative or accusative as context decides; *Domini*: masculine singular genitive modifying it, “Body of the Lord”.
3. Transform *Deus bonus animam custodit* so that plural gods guard plural souls.
Answer / model: *Dei boni animas custodiunt*. Nominative subject, adjective, accusative object, and verb number all change.
4. Explain why *Patris* and *Patri* are not interchangeable in “the name of the Father” and “glory to the Father”.
Answer / model: *Patris* is genitive singular for possession: *nomen Patris*. *Patri* is dative singular for recipient: *gloria Patri*.
5. Diagnose and correct *dona nos pacem*, intended “grant us peace”.
Answer / model: *Dona nobis pacem*. Recipient “us” requires dative *nobis*; direct object *pacem* remains accusative.
6. **Text:** *Corpus Domini nostri Iesu Christi custodiat animam meam*.
Passage ID: I.8.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.
 Draw the genitive and agreement links, identify subject and object, and translate.
Answer / notes: Subject: neuter singular nominative *Corpus*. Genitive name chain *Domini nostri Iesu Christi* depends on it; *nostri* agrees with *Domini*. Object: feminine singular accusative *animam meam*. “May the Body of our Lord Jesus Christ preserve my soul.”

Part VI

Scope and Sources

CHAPTER 1

Scope and Qualifications

1.1 Packet boundary

This is module EL-I.2, *Case, Number, Gender, and Agreement*, in Triptych's print-first Ecclesiastical Latin curriculum. It imports one authoritative lesson, transfer practice for its internal submodules, two selected worksheets, one local mastery assessment, and matching solutions. This packet establishes the case-and-agreement decision process; it does not yet teach complete declensional paradigms.

The unprinted worksheet variants remain course-owned extension material; their omission is intentional and is not a claim that the module exhausts available practice. EL-GUIDE owns the course-wide study method, pacing, lookup discipline, answer protocol, source classes, and advancement rules; this packet assumes that orientation and terminology taught in prerequisite modules.

1.2 Controlling records and local state

Course-wide research records own the edition, passage, answer, curriculum, and source decisions; the leaf's module map records this packet's selection and transfer practice. EL-GUIDE owns the corpus, normalization, translation, non-authority, review, and answer conventions that apply here. Claim-local qualifications remain beside the affected material; check received wording against the course-wide passage inventory.

Any installed snapshot is a working study held from release until its exact bytes and outstanding distribution gates receive separate authorization.

CHAPTER 2

References

The following works are the course's controlling corpus and reference aids. Project-composed explanation, translation, analysis, exercises, and models are distinguished from received wording under the convention stated in the Scope and Qualifications appendix. Short source passages are identified so that the learner can verify their wider context. The adjacent edition manifest and passage inventory record exact source roles, checks, access states, and known rights limits.

2.1 Primary corpus

- Catholic Church, *Missale Romanum ex decreto SS. Concilii Tridentini restitutum, Summorum Pontificum cura recognitum*, editio typica (Rome, 1962). A searchable presentation of the edition is hosted by the Holy See's Biblia Clerus project: <https://www.clerus.org/bibliaclerusonline/EN/gmb.htm>.
- A page-image scan of the 1962 typical edition is available through the Church Music Association of America: <https://media.churchmusicassociation.org/pdf/missale62.pdf>. Page images, rather than unsourced transcriptions, should decide doubtful punctuation or spelling.

- The Clementine Vulgate is the principal biblical comparison corpus. The public-domain 1914 edition edited by Michael Hetzenauer and its provenance are described at <https://www.sacredbible.org/vulgate1914/>.

2.2 Grammar and lexicography

- J. H. Allen and J. B. Greenough, *New Latin Grammar for Schools and Colleges* (1903), a donor-declared public-domain reference whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <https://archive.org/details/allengreenoughsn01alle>.
- Charles E. Bennett, *New Latin Grammar*, 1918 revision, Project Gutenberg eBook 15665; public-domain text in the United States: <https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/15665>.
- Charlton T. Lewis and Charles Short, *A Latin Dictionary* (1879), searchable transcription: <https://logeion.uchicago.edu/lexidium>.
- Charles du Fresne, sieur du Cange, *Glossarium mediae et infimae latinitatis*, a donor-declared later-vocabulary aid whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <http://ducange.enc.sorbonne.fr/>.

The underlying 1903, 1918, 1879, and 1883–1887 printed works are public domain in the United States. Digital transcriptions and interfaces retain their own terms and are cited as access tools, not relicensed or reproduced wholesale. The 1962 Missal, Scripture, official text, and other received wording retain their own status; see the scope appendix, research records, and final-page rights notice.

Classical reference grammars describe the inherited system but do not by themselves explain every biblical or ecclesiastical development. The advanced volume therefore distinguishes classical baseline, Vulgate usage, later Christian usage, and stable liturgical formula instead of labeling every difference an “exception.”

2.3 Citation convention

Missal passages are cited by liturgical location and text genre rather than by a page number that varies among printings. Biblical texts are cited by book, chapter, and verse. Historical authors are cited by work and section wherever possible. A learner preparing a formal commentary should verify each passage against the edition actually being used and record any variant. These references are not a claim that every historical-linguistic question can be settled by the listed school grammars and dictionary interfaces.

CHAPTER 3

Generation Metadata

Last revised (UTC): 2026-07-21T17:50:56Z

Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; unexposed: exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (curriculum architecture, module design, enrichment, source and answer audit, correction, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum structure audit, shared typesetting and selection correction, rendered-structure regression checks, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (whole-curriculum Part-scoped numbering and rendered contents hierarchy correction, rendered contents-geometry regression checking, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (starter-guide consolidation, module-flow and definition-retrieval revision, stage-boundary assessment correction, catalog and audit records, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

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